



1. Languages of Pakistan

Language is the most important part of culture because it is the effective way of the expression of ideas and feelings. Language is the identity of a nation. That is why every nation loves its language and takes all possible steps for its development.

There are many countries of the world where more than one language is spoken. All languages spoken in a country are part of its culture. One of these languages, however, is used as a link language and is known as the national language.

The national language helps in bringing the people of different areas closer to each other and is a source of unity and national cohesion. The national language enjoys a preference over all other languages in a country without relegating them to the background. But, the regional languages should by no means be neglected. All the provincial languages are cultural assets of the nation, which continue to prosper in their respective areas.

More than 30 languages are spoken in Pakistan. The major provincial languages of our country include Sindhi, Punjabi, Pashto, Balochi and Brahvi. These languages represent their respective provinces and are known as provincial languages. The national language of Pakistan is Urdu, which is understood and spoken with minor difference of accent in all parts of Pakistan. At the time of creation of Pakistan, the Quaid-i-Azam declared in unequivocal terms that Urdu would be the national language of Pakistan. The 1973 constitution of Pakistan also declared Urdu as the official language.

I) Urdu

Urdu is a part of our cultural heritage. About 3000 years ago the Aryan people came through Central Asia and settled down in the northern part of South Asia. As their number increased, they drove the original inhabitants out of this region towards the south. The Aryans spoke Sanskrit language. The local influence brought about some changes in this language. This low Standard Sanskrit language came to be known as Prakrit (the language of the common people). Thus, for about fifteen hundred years the common people spoke Prakrit. Once again, Raja Vikrama Ditta declared Sanskrit as the official, intellectual and literary language. However, the common people continued speaking Prakrit.

The Prakrit language took four distinctive forms with the passage of time and one of those local forms was the Brij Bhasha which was the

language spoken in the land between and around the Ganges and Jumna rivers.

Different Muslim dynasties ruled South Asia. First the Pathans and then the Mughals established their rule here. They spoke Persian which had several words borrowed from Arabic and Turkish languages.

During the Mughal rule, many European nations came to South Asia with one or the other purpose. This way certain French and Portuguese words were added to the Brij language, so much so that during the rule of Shah Jahan (1627-1658), the Brij language had undergone such an internal change that it looked like a new language. This new language was understood and spoken both by the Hindus and Muslims. Since the Mughal rulers recruited their army from different castes and religions, this new language became popular with the armed forces. The army camp in the Turkish language is called "ordoo" (horde), which is derived from the word "orda" (camp) from Mongolian language. Under the Persian influence the word "ordoo" became softer as "urdu". Its splendour is Turkish and its charm is Persian in its base. The Arabic words borrowed by the Turkish and Persian languages were also adopted by this new Urdu Language.

During the last 200 years of the Mughal rule (1658-1857) the religious scholars, intellectuals and poets adopted Urdu as the language of expression, the other one being the Persian language. In this way this language got a new vista for its promotion and propagation. In its nature Urdu is capable of borrowing from all other languages and as soon as the borrowed words got currency, they became an integral part of the language.

Urdu played a vital role in promoting Pakistan Movement. It is spoken and understood in all the provinces of Pakistan. It is a sign of national unity. A number of words from local languages are taking their place in Urdu language. Urdu has also influenced the local languages and Urdu words are used in the spoken Sindhi language as well as in Punjabi language.

Urdu has made great progress in Pakistan. It has a valuable treasure of poetry and prose. Our writers and poets have enriched this language and played an important role to make it popular among the masses of Pakistan. Urdu dramas, Urdu feature films and sweet songs in Urdu made it easier to understand its meaning and content. Urdu is also a medium of instruction and a medium of examination. Modern knowledge and subjects are being translated into Urdu. For the development of Urdu

two Federal level Colleges namely Urdu Science College and Urdu Arts College were set up at Karachi and now have been declared as Urdu University. Government has established a National Language Authority at Islamabad to promote Urdu language.

II) Sindhi

Sindhi is one of the oldest South Asian languages. With the arrival of the Muslims, the Sindhi language started taking strides and several Arabic, Persian and Turkish words entered this language. Sindhi is written in a modified Arabic script. Sindhi language has the distinction of being the first local language in which the Holy Qur'an was translated during the Muslim rule.

The Sindhi poetry of the mystic saints is equally popular not only in Sindh province but also in other parts of Pakistan. Shah Abdul Latif Bhittai and Sachal Sarmast are the most prominent poets of mysticism in Sindhi poetry. The people get solace in their poetry and are proud of them.

The Sindhi language began to wear its modern look towards the later part of the nineteenth century. In the twentieth century, this language has made considerable progress in the realms of prose and poetry; constant contributions are being made in short stories, novels, dramas, travelogue, essays and all other facets of modern prose. Similarly, commendable progress has been made in poetry. Besides traditional verse forms such as ghazal, nazm, mathnavi, rubaee, etc. many western, Chinese and Japanese forms have also been introduced. Thus the Sindhi language of today has a very rich treasure of knowledge and literature. There are about a dozen important daily newspapers and more than a hundred weekly and as many fortnightly, monthly, quarterly magazines and journals being published in Sindhi.

The University of Sindh and the Karachi University have the departments of Sindhi language where Master's and the Doctorate degrees are being awarded. Sindhi is being taught in schools and colleges and is also a medium of answer, right from primary classes to graduate level in the examinations and also at post-graduate level. Sindhi is the official language of the Sindh province. Sindhi Language Authority has been established in 1990 for the promotion of Sindhi language. Sindhi Adabi Board promotes Sindhi language and literature by publishing standard classical and modern works.

III) Punjabi

The language of the Punjab province is "Punjabi". The Punjabi vocabulary includes words from Arabic, Turkish and Persian languages. Although there are minor differences of dialect in the Punjabi spoken in different parts of Punjab, yet the basic language is the same. Some ancient Buddhist monks wrote religious or devotional lyrics in Punjabi, which are considered as the earliest pieces of Punjabi literature. Proper work in Punjabi literature really started after the arrival of Muslims in South Asia. Most of the religious scholars of Islam and mystics of this area used Punjabi language for expressing their ideas and for propagation of the religion. Some of the great mystic poets and preachers, who composed their works in Punjabi, include Baba Fareed Ganj Shakar, Shah Hussain, Sultan Bahu, Bulhe Shah, Waris Shah, Hashim Shah, Ali Haider Multani, Mian Muhammad Bakhsh and Khawaja Ghulam Fareed.

With the advent of the 20th century, novels, plays, short stories and other forms of prose began to be written in the Punjabi language along with the beginning of Punjabi journalism. This was followed by addition of new dimensions to the Punjabi literature, for instance, books on art, philosophy, history, linguistics, economics, geography, traditional medicines (Tibb) and law were written. As a result, this language today has a vast treasure of published and unpublished masterpieces. Punjabi is taught as an optional subject in Punjab. There is a Department of Punjabi language in the University of Punjab where education is imparted at Master's and Doctorate level. Punjabi language is well-set on the road to development and its literature is continuously, growing richer. A large number of young Punjabi writers, dramatists and poets have emerged during the last 35 years. Punjabi dramas and films have brought great effect on the minds of the people and made the language richer and popular among the masses.

IV) Pashto

The language of the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa Province is Pashto. It is also spoken in North-West of Balochistan. In the ancient times, the tribes of eastern Iran settled in the area between the Indus River and Hindukush range. Sanjani and Pamir languages are the existing remnants of some of the languages spoken by them. The Pashto language sprang from the base of these languages. In addition to the ancient Pashto literature. The famous Pashto poets of the 17th and 18th century such as Kazim Khan

Shaida, Rehman Baba and Khushhal Khan Khattak wrote a large number of lyrical poems in Pashto. About the same period, Pashto grammar was also compiled. Towards the end of the 19th Century, the foundation of modern Pashto literature was laid. About the same period, Pashto journalism made a beginning. Folk songs and folk tales were also preserved in Pashto. Today Pashto language has a vast treasure of literary works. Many journals are published in Pashto language. Peshawar University is taking necessary steps to promote this language. Pashto Academy at Peshawar University is making every effort to develop and modernize Pashto. There is also a Pashto Academy at Quetta.

v) **Balochi**

The language of the Baloch tribe's of Balochistan is Balochi. Besides, Balochi, Pashto, Brahvi and Sindhi languages are also spoken in this province. Balochi is linked with the ancient languages that were spoken in the Southern and Eastern Iran. The Baloch tribes came from north eastern Iran and settled in that region of South Asia which is now called Balochistan. They brought with them the ancient Balochi language. But Balochi could not make any noteworthy progress in the beginning. The first Balochi monthly magazine was published in 1952 from Karachi, but it could not survive. During this period, a number of organizations came up to develop Balochi language and literature. At present Balochi literature is on the road to progress. Besides epical romantic poetry, folk stories are features of Balochi literature. Jam Vark, Mast Tawakkali, Gul Khan Naseer, Azad Jamaluddin, N. M. Danish and Banul Dashtyari (Naz Bibi) are well-known amongst the writers who have contributed to the development of this language. The Balochistan University and the Balochi Academy are rendering great service to the Balochi language.

In addition to the above mentioned provincial languages, some other significant regional languages of Pakistan are Sheena, Balti, Brahvi, Chitrali, Kashmiri, Kohistani, Hindko and Siraiki. These languages are spoken in the respective parts of the country.



Importance of National language vis-a-vis National Unity

Although all provincial languages are equally important, yet the need and importance of a national language cannot be denied. Every nation needs some marks of identity. Language is the prime mark of

identification for any nation. Pakistan is a strong federation of four provinces and its national language is Urdu, which enjoys the protection of the constitution. The father of the nation, Quaid-i-Azam Mohammad Ali Jinnah had also declared Urdu as the national language of Pakistan. Urdu serves, as the means of coordination between different provinces of Pakistan need to converse with each other, they need a link language. The national language creates a feeling of unity and national cohesion. People living in different provinces realize that in spite of speaking different languages, they are joined together by one national language, which is the heritage of all. This is why the Urdu poetry and prose is getting its contributors from every province of Pakistan. We find poets and writers from Sindh, Punjab, Balochistan and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, whose works in Urdu are a valuable contribution to Urdu literature it is evident from the above facts that Urdu truly deserves to be recognized as our national language which has acquired great importance for creating national unity.

a) Source of contact

It is an important source of co-ordination and developing contact among the people of Pakistan. It is spoken and understood in all the provinces of Pakistan. Hence, it is a source of national integration and solidarity.

b) Role in Pakistan Movement

In the early stages of Pakistan Movement, Urdu was the most favoured language. This language was developed during the Muslim rule over South Asia. Urdu became distinct and prominent because it absorbed Arabic, Persian, Turkish and English vocabulary. Islamic culture gave it a distinct identity and made it popular among the Muslims. Many Muslim leaders like Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, Abdul Majeed Sindhi, Allama Iqbal, Hasrat Mohani, Allama Shibli Nomani, Quaid-i-Azam and several others favoured Urdu against Hindi and proved that Urdu was the only language of the sub-continent in which literature of Islam existed in abundance. Urdu created unity among the people.

c) Common ology

Urdu as National Language of Pakistan and the provincial languages have an intimate relationship. All these languages have been influenced by Arabic Persian and English and, hence, contain a large number of common words. Literature on identical topics is available in all the languages.

d) Media Communication

Radio, television and press which are the main media of communication are playing an important role in the promotion of national unity through national and provincial languages. Common heritage of these languages have been exposed to the people who has strengthened the national language. This has created harmony among the people of different regions of Pakistan.

e) Source of benefit

The writings in provincial languages like folk tales, essays, plays, poetry and songs are being translated into Urdu language for the purpose of maximum benefit of people to understand it and also develop goodwill among the people.

f) Co-ordination

Pakistan is a federation of four provinces. Urdu serves as the medium of co-ordination between different provinces of Pakistan. Urdu is, therefore, playing an important role in national unity.

g) International Language

Urdu literature is spread all over the country as well as out of the country. Urdu ranks with International languages.

h) Common Medium

Every nation has a language, which serves as a means of co-ordination and unity among its people. Islam is the binding force for Muslims. Urdu which became a common medium of preaching message of Islam occupied a unique status. It is because of this reason that it is national language of Pakistan.

3. Common cultural manifestation in the national life

All the four provinces of Pakistan have their own provincial languages. Also there is slight difference between the customs and the ways of living of the people belonging to different provinces. But the distinction of the cultural heritage of Pakistan is the Islamic civilization, which presented principles of equality, fraternity, brotherhood, justice and truth. This system further influenced the knowledge and literature, architecture, music, art and linguistics. The accomplishments of the Muslims in these fields form our cultural legacy. We are known with reference to Islamic heritage. Islam has knit the people of Pakistan into brotherhood. Therefore, common cultural manifestation in the national life is as under:-

i. Mixed culture

Pakistan has a mixed culture; which is very important from its basic structure. People of each region are influenced by its environment. The effects of the surroundings become evident from their dress, food and patterns of living. In Pakistan people from different origins settled, which included Arabs, Iranian, and Turkish etc. They were the followers of their own regional customs and traditions. Their dress, language and culture were different. All these cultures mixed with each other and produced a common Pakistani culture.

ii. Status of Men and Women

Male member has occupied a unique status in Pakistani culture. He is the head of the family. He is the dominant member. But a woman is also considered an important part of the family who governs and manages all family affairs within the four walls. Household keeping and upbringing of children is entrusted to her in a family. She has the right to education, right to property and right to business in accordance with the principles of Islam. The rights and duties of men and women are determined in the light of the teachings of Islam. These principles are equally followed in all the four provinces of Pakistan and, hence, form common cultural heritage of Pakistan.

iii. Social life

Social life in Pakistan is simple. People believe in old traditions. Their customs and traditions are simple and interesting generally, joint family system is followed. People are taught to respect elders and love children. People are knit in the relation of love and respect for each other. Women are shown great respect. Majority of the people live in the villages and are engaged in agriculture and flock keeping. Marriages are performed in the traditional manner and are very colourful. Huge money is spent on the marriages. People are also employed in different sectors of national economy. Social life is, therefore, common in all parts of Pakistan with a little variation in the observance of different events under climatic or environmental conditions.



iv. Food

Most of the people in Pakistan eat simple food. They eat wheat, bread, rice, meat, pulses and vegetables. They drink tea, simple water and beverages. They also eat local fruits and the fruits of different regions of the country. Therefore, eating habits are common to each province.

v. Entertainments

Our entertainments and pursuits of leisure are similar. Hockey, cricket, squash, kabaddi and wrestling are equally popular throughout the country. People take interest in these games and, therefore, these have become our national games. These games reflect our common national culture.

vi. Religious events

Common cultural heritage is witnessed in our religious events and ceremonies. Marriage is a sacred religious task in our culture and it reflects Islamic tradition and colour. People wear colourful dresses at the occasion of marriages, sing cheerful songs, exchange gifts and invite people on delicious meals. A house where marriage takes place is identified by the colourful lights, music bands and singing of music. Marriage becomes a source of hustle and bustle. This shows our common cultural heritage.

Similarly there are certain traditions of birth and death. Birth of a child, especially male child is celebrated. Gifts are presented to each other. At the time of death of a person people share sorrows with the grieved family. The neighbours, relatives and friends arrange for the food on that occasion. In this way people promote brotherhood with each other.

Other festivals like Eid Milad-un-Nabi, Eid-ul-Fitr and Eid-ul-Azha are celebrated in a grand manner. People wear dresses, cook varieties of food and exchange gifts. A great sense of brotherhood is expressed on all these occasions.

vii. Single message of love and brotherhood

Our cultural heritage is reflected through our regional literature and literary values. A single message of love and brotherhood has been conveyed by our saints in different languages. The literature produced by

different writers in different languages conveys the message of peace, humanity, mysticism, justice, love and co-operation. Shah Abdul Latif Bhitai and Sachal Sarmast in Sindh, Sultan Bahu, Bulhe Shah, Waris Shah in Punjab, Rehman Baba, and Khushhal Khan in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Gul Khan Naseer in Balochistan have taught us love and brotherhood. They are the symbol of our common cultural heritage.

viii. Media of communication

Radio, television, newspapers, magazines and means of transport are the source of developing national coordination and common national culture.

ix. System of Education

National culture develops through the system of education followed at the national level. The uniformity in our system of education through uniform courses of studies, system of supervision and the system of examination and evaluation help in inculcating national spirit and making the children conscious of our common cultural values. This creates national harmony, promotes common culture and helps the new generation to maintain a link with their cultural heritage.



4. Dress, festivals, arts and crafts

Pakistan is a vast country. Due to variation in geographical and climatic conditions there is great variety in the dress, customs, festivals and arts and crafts of the people living in different areas. This has made our culture rich and colourful. The colourful versatility may be witnessed in the following aspects of our culture:-

i. Dress

Pakistan's national dress is very simple but impressive. Men wear shirt and shalwar combined with waistcoat and turban. Women wear shirt, shalwar and dupatta. But there is difference in the design of the dress of men and women. However, climatic conditions affect the choice and selection of dress. In cold areas the dress is made with thick woollen clothes. In Punjab, Sindh and Balochistan light dress is used in summer and thick woollen or cotton dress is used in winter. The dress of the people of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa is the same except that the people living in

extreme cold areas where thick woollen clothes are used in winter. Coat and trousers used in all parts of the country but mostly in urban areas. On the whole, the national dress consists of shalwar and shirt.

ii. Literature and Fine Arts

Printing, calligraphy, architecture and music are considered as fine arts. During the Muslim period these arts flourished in South Asia. Their accomplishment is our cultural heritage. In Pakistan our artists created the noble works of paintings. Our calligraphers created unique models of Islamic or Quranic calligraphy. Traditional architecture is reflected in the construction of beautiful buildings. In music new experiments have been made through mixing of our traditional music and the modern tunes. Through television and stage dramas, fine art has been promoted. Stone carving and preparation of ornaments with metal and iron are the master piece works and models of fine art.

iii. Handicrafts

High quality handicrafts have been produced in all the areas of Pakistan through ages. These handicrafts are produced by women working in their homes. Some of these handicrafts are produced jointly by men and women, In Sindh, glass cut work on clothes is very fine and exclusive. Sindhi Ajrak, colourful sheets (chadors) are very prominent and appreciated. In Karachi, ornaments and decoration pieces are made of shells and stones. Embroidery and glass cut work done in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa is of high quality. Punjab has a name in its handicrafts. Multani camel skin lamps and painted vessels of Bahawalpur show artistic and designed work of the people of the area. Engraved furniture is made in Chiniot. The glass work and embroidery of Balochistan is of high standard, especially the Balochi embroidery is an excellent artistic work. The handicrafts industry exists in most of the towns, cities and villages of Pakistan, which is a source of providing employment to the people on the one hand and a source of enrichment of our culture. Handicrafts of Pakistan are also a source of earning foreign exchange.

iv. Festivals and Fairs

Many festivals and fairs are held in Pakistan every year. These occasions provide entertainment and joy to the people of Pakistan.

These are:

- a) **Eid-ul-Fitr:** It is celebrated after the month of Ramazan ends and on the first of Shawwal. This is a reward in the form of blessings of Allah to those Muslims who fasted for the whole month of Ramazan. People wear good dresses, eat vermicelli's and exchange gifts. Poor people are helped in cash and kind by the rich.
- b) **Eid-ul-Azha:** It is celebrated on the 10th, of the month of Zil-Hajj in the memory of the great sacrifice of Hazrat Ibrahim, when he offered to sacrifice the life of his dearest son Hazrat Ismail to fulfill the decree of Almighty Allah. On Eid-ul-Azha people sacrifice animals and distribute meat among their relatives, friends, neighbours and the poor. The sacrifice is offered for three days i.e. 10th, 11th and 12th of Zil-Hajj.
- c) **Eid Milad-un-Nabi:** It is celebrated on 12th of the Islamic month of Rabi-ul-Awwal with great love and devotion. It is celebrated to express happiness on the birth of our Holy Last Prophet Hazrat Muhammad (**حَضْرَتُ مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ**). Homes, streets and bazaars are decorated and illuminated. Religious meetings are held. It is celebrated with great devotion and zeal.



- d) **Celebration of Non-Muslim Festivals:** The non-Muslim citizens also participate in the celebrations of Muslim festivals but they have their own festivals. Christians celebrate the birth of Hazrat Isa (Jesus Christ) on 25th December and Easter festival in April. Muslims share their happiness. Similarly, Hindu and Sikhs also celebrate their festivals of Diwali, Ram Leela, Holi, Rakhi Bandhan and Besakhi etc. Pakistanis share their feelings of happiness and festivity.
- e) **Fairs:** Fairs are the big features of Pakistani culture. Normally these fairs are held at the eve of Urs (birth or death anniversary) of great saints and Sufis. A large number of people travel from distant places and participate in these fairs. In rural areas some fairs are held after the harvesting season. These fairs are great events of meeting friends and others, doing shopping and promoting economic activities.

The most famous fairs of Pakistan are:-

- i. Urs of Hazrat Data Ganj Bakhsh, Lahore, Punjab.
- ii. Urs of Hazrat Mian Mir, Lahore, Punjab.
- iii. Urs of Hazrat Bahauddin Zakaria, Multan, Punjab.
- iv. Urs of Shah Rukn Alam, Multan, Punjab.
- v. Urs of Hazrat Shahdullah Deryai, Gujrat, Punjab.
- vi. Urs of Hazrat Abdul Latif Imam Bari, Islamabad.
- vii. Urs of Hazrat Shah Abdul Latif Bhitai, Bhit Shah, Sindh.
- viii. Urs of Hazrat Sachal Sarmast, Daraza,
- ix. Urs of Hazrat Lal Shahbaz Qalandar, Sehwan, Sindh.
- x. Urs of Hazrat Abdullah Shah Ghazi, Clifton, Karachi Sindh.

All these fairs (Melas) and festivals are valuable assets of our culture. These events help in enhancing our social and economic progress, strengthening our cultural relations and prove useful in creating national cohesion and unity.

EXERCISE

A. Answer the following questions:

1. Describe the characteristics of culture.
2. Why language is an important element of culture?
3. Write a note on the languages of Pakistan.
4. Describe the importance of Urdu as a national language.
5. What are the common cultural manifestations in the national life?
6. Write down a note on the arts and crafts of Pakistan.
7. Describe the importance of festivals as a part of our culture.

B. Fill in the blanks.

- i. Pakistan's national language is _____.
- ii. Pakistan's culture is a _____ culture.
- iii. The national dress of Pakistan is _____ and _____.
- iv. In Pakistan _____ languages are spoken.
- v. In Balochistan two languages _____ and _____ are spoken.
- vi. The two great poets of Balochi are _____ and _____.
- vii. Shah Hussain is a great _____ poet.
- viii. After independence Sindhi language has made lot of progress in _____ and _____.
- ix. Most of the people in Pakistan eat _____ food.
- x. A single message of _____ and _____ has been conveyed by our saints in different languages.
- xi. Eid-ul-Fitr is celebrated in the month of _____.
- xii. Christians celebrate on _____ on _____.

Chapter 09

EDUCATION IN PAKISTAN



1. Importance of Education for development with particular reference to Pakistan Education Policy

Education occupies a fundamental place in the development and progress of a country; and thereby the individuals are enriched with the wealth of knowledge. Education is the only faculty which increases with its use. The importance of education is that:-

- i. It helped humankind to pass through many stages of evolution and reached to the present age of science and high technology.
- ii. It helped the humankind to conquer the forces of nature on the earth and also explored a number of secrets of space.
- iii. It helps in understanding the ideology of a nation and suggests ways to strengthen this ideology.
- iv. It develops a sense of nationhood and patriotism among the individuals.
- v. It helps in understanding the rights and duties of a citizen to perform his or her role for the welfare and progress of the society.
- vi. It helps in developing creative abilities of people to accelerate the process of healthy and constructive change in the society.
- vii. It helps to understand that educational development and economic progress are linked with each other. With a high standard of education more skilled people will be produced who will work for the progress and development of the country.
- viii. It helps in the optimum utilization and exploitation of natural resources.

- ix. It is the best investment in human resource development. Through education scientific and technological advancement is possible.

Pakistan Education Policy

Importance of education is evident from the Education policies introduced by the Government in different periods. Following education policies have been introduced in the country since its independence in 1947:

- i. Educational Conference 1947.
- ii. Report of the Commission on National Education 1959.
- iii. Education Policy 1972-80.
- iv. Education Policy 1978.
- v. National Education Policy 1998-2010.

From 1947 to 1998 all the policies emphasized upon the promotion of literacy, universal primary education, improvement in the quality of education and promotion of science and technical education. Stress was also laid on the quality of teacher training, improvement in the textbooks and the examination and evaluation system. High targets were set for improving primary education and literacy rate but in reality those targets could not be achieved. After 62 years, literacy rate is 51%. The important aspect of Education Policy 1972-80 was nationalisation of private institutions but it damaged the system of education. In the policy of 1978 teaching of Islamiat and Pakistan Studies was made compulsory from class IX to degree level. During this period Social Action Programme was started for improvement of education by opening new schools for female children. Literacy Commission was set up with an objective of spreading literacy in the country. But in practice the objectives of education could not be achieved as per targets set in the policies due to meager allocation of funds for different sectors of education, defective supervision and mismanagement of the educational institutions. Private sector was totally ignored and was kept away to share in the promotion of education. The examination system suffered from a number of malpractices. The Teacher Training System could not be improved. Therefore, government decided to prepare a comprehensive Education Policy to meet the challenges of the modern world. In this perspective National Education Policy 1998-2010 was prepared and enforced in the country.

National Education Policy 1998-2010

National Education Policy 1998-2010 stressed the need and importance of the following aspects of education within the country:

- i. Education will be accessible to all the citizens because it is the right of the individual citizen of Pakistan.
- ii. In order to eradicate illiteracy all possible formal and non-formal means will be used. By the year 2010 the gross enrolment of children in the primary age group (5-9) will rise to 105%.
- iii. Compulsory Primary Education Act has been promulgated and enforced from the year 2004-05.
- iv. A separate stream of Matric (Technical) will be added to general education for those who plan to pursue higher education. Facilities for technical education will be increased including undertaking of training programme for training of technical and vocational teachers to cope with the increasing demand of teachers.
- v. Technological and scientific knowledge will be expanded by introducing computer education as a subject at secondary and above level. The opportunities will be provided for technical teaching.
- vi. The existing capacity of teacher training institutions shall be fully utilized. The quality of teacher education programmes will be raised by prescribing the qualification of primary teachers from Matric to Intermediate. Two parallel programmes of FA / F.Sc. Education and B.A. / B.Sc. Education have been launched. The curricula of teacher education will be revised to bring it at par with other programmes in the region.
- vii. Education Foundations have been established for providing financial assistance to the private sector for opening non-commercial educational institutions especially in rural areas.
- viii. A District Education Authority will be established in each district to ensure public participation in the monitoring and implementation of all educational programmes.
- ix. The national budget for education will be increased from 2.2% to 4% of the total national income.
- x. The policy provided for the upgradation of the quality of education in Deeni Madaris (Schools of Islamic Education) and to bring Deeni Madaris and modern schools closer to each stream in curriculum and the content of education.

- xi. To promote sports and games from the grassroots at all the tiers of the education system.

Political, Social, Cultural and Economic Aspects of Education

a. Political aspect

Education plays an important role in the politics of a country. Education is the first condition for the success of democracy. In democracy people share in the affairs of the government by giving their opinion and practical support. This is only possible when the masses are educated. In the developed countries people are 100% educated. They have vision of their problems. They are not deceived by their political leaders. They make their leaders accountable to them. An educated person is never influenced by the emotional lectures and the false promises of the politicians. Education plays an important role in the formation of public opinion. The role of the press can be more effective when people are educated. Government can be confronted with strong reaction on any of the issue if people are educated. On the contrary semi-literate or illiterate political leaders cannot run the affairs of the government.

b. Socio-cultural aspect

Illiteracy is the root cause of all social evils. A number of social and cultural traditions are in practice due to lack of education. There are a number of customs and traditions, which are contrary to Islamic teachings and values, for example, air shooting at the time of marriages, quarrels on the appearance of moon and the use of drugs. The intellectual level of people is manifested in their culture. Hence, cultural values can only be purposeful if people have certain level of education. The art, poetry, literature and music cannot be appreciated without education. The decency in the daily affairs and dealing with others will be possible with the instrument of education. An educated person is distinguished by his manners. The wealth alone cannot raise the cultural life but it is the education which makes the people cultured and civilized. So education is an important agent of change in the attitude, behaviour and the way to live. It helps in eradicating social evils.

c. Economic aspect

Quality of education and its high standard have direct impact upon

the economic development of the country. The research and quality of education brings innovation and improvement in the industrial and agricultural products. Art has its own value which can be learnt and improved with education. Half of the national income of USA and UK is achieved through the services of its experts in different human activities like, banking, insurance, air service, trade, law, etc. The educated class of workers and skill personnel help in increasing the quantity and the quality of agricultural and industrial products. The literacy rate of all developed industrial countries is 98% to 100%. Their standard of scientific and technological education is very high. Human resources become productive due to quality of education. In Pakistan the reason for slow development is lack of qualitative and quantitative education. Investment in education is less than 3% which keeps us far behind in economic development.

2. Formal Education System

Formal system of education means provision of education by establishing different educational institutions, prescribing textbooks, appointing teachers, establishing a system of examination and awarding certificates and degrees. Rules and regulations for formal system of education are prepared and implemented. The system is controlled with these rules. There is a certain period of study for certain level to earn a certificate or degree. The spirit of formal system lies in management, control and discipline. The formal system is fully controlled by the government.

In Pakistan the formal system is categorized as follows:-

- i. **Primary stage:** It starts from class I to V. Its total duration is 5 years. Children are admitted in class-I at the age of 4 or 5 years of age.
- ii. **Middle stage:** It starts from class VI to VIII. Its duration is 3 years. Children after passing primary stage are admitted in class VI. A certificate is issued by the school after passing middle stage.
- iii. **Secondary stage:** It starts from class IX to X. Its duration is 2 years. Students who have passed Middle Stage are admitted in class IX. The Board issues a certificate on passing Secondary School Examination.
- iv. **Higher Secondary stage:** It starts from class XI to XII. Students after passing secondary school examination are admitted in the Higher Secondary class. Its duration is 2 years.

A certificate is issued by the Board after passing the examination of this stage.

- v. **Degree level:** It starts after the students pass Higher Secondary level of education and are admitted in a college to earn a degree. The government has raised its duration from 2 to 3 years. Now it starts from the 13th year to 15th year of studies. University issues a degree to successful candidates. However, in many parts of the country, the Degree course is of duration of two years.
- vi. **University level:** It starts after the students pass degree level examination from the college. Its duration is 2 years. Degree is issued by the University on successful completion of the course and passing the examination.
- vii. **Professional Education:** Professional education, which is also formal education, is divided into the following:-
 - a. **Diploma:** The students who pass the Secondary School Certificate examination get admission in diploma courses taught in the Polytechnic institutions in the area of electrical, mechanical, automobile, civil engineering and computers. The students who do not want to get higher education for any reason join diploma courses.
 - b. **Engineering Degree:** After passing Higher Secondary level examination the students who had opted Mathematics at higher secondary level get admission in different branches of engineering in the Engineering Colleges or University. They study in electrical, mechanical, chemical, electronics, mining, textiles, petroleum and computer science. Their duration of study is 4 to 5 years.
 - c. **Medical Degree:** After passing Higher Secondary examination the students who opted Biology as a subject at higher secondary level, seek admission in MBBS to become a doctor. The duration of studies at MBBS is 5 years.
 - d. **Commerce:** The students after passing secondary school examination are admitted in the first year Commerce class.

They pass Inter Commerce and further B.Commerce (B.Com) and M.Commerce (M.Com). The subjects of study induce business and administration, management sciences, information technology, economics, accounting etc.:

- e. **Agricultural Degree:** After passing higher secondary examination in science, students are admitted for B.sc (Agriculture) and after that to M.Sc. (Agriculture). Some go for degrees in Agricultural Engineering."
- viii. **Higher Education:** Higher Education can be had after passing. M.A. or M.Sc. or M.Com. degree examinations. The degree of Ph.D. can be obtained after earning Master degrees. Similarly, after MBBS doctors specialize in a number of branches of medicine. They are called specialized doctors.

In order to provide formal education, government has established a number of institutions throughout Pakistan. Education in the formal system is generally controlled by the government and rules and regulations of the government are followed. However, there are private institutions in the formal system at all levels of education. But the fee of private institutions is much higher than that in government institutions. The fee is generally not affordable by the poor and middle classes of the country.

3. Scheme of Studies

Scheme of studies means the courses / syllabi prescribed at different levels. Scheme of studies at different level of education are quite distinct from each other. These schemes are as follows:

- i. **Primary level:** The subjects at the primary level include the regional languages, Urdu, Counting, simple Arithmetic, Nature study and Islamiat.
- ii. **Middle level:** The subjects included in the scheme and taught are Regional Languages, Urdu, English, Algebra, Geometry, Science, Social Studies and Islamiat.
- iii. **Secondary level:** At this level Urdu, English, Islamiat, Pakistan Studies are the compulsory subjects for all groups of students. Humanities group of students opt for General Science as compulsory

subject. Apart, they opt for Mathematics and two other subjects in Humanities. Science students, study Physics, Chemistry, Mathematics and Biology along with compulsory subjects.

- iv. **Higher Secondary level:** At this level Urdu, English, Islamiat and Pakistan Studies are compulsory, subjects for both Arts (Humanities) and Science groups of students. Science group students opt for 3 Science subject and Arts group and Arts subjects. Science has further 3 groups namely Pre-medical group, Pre-engineering group and General Science group. Students of Commerce group also opt for 3 commerce subjects.
- v. **Degree level:** Functional English, Pakistan Studies and Islamiat are compulsory at B.A/B.Sc. level. Two to three optional subjects are taken by the students of all the groups from the list of optional subjects.
- vi. **University level:** At Master level the students study in any one of the disciplines in education. In each discipline they study 7 to 8 subjects. Here students have variety of choices or subjects of their interest.

After the University level (M.A. / M.Sc.) the students can go for M.Phil. or Ph.D. in the subject they had chosen at M.A. / M.Sc. level. Those taking degrees of professional nature are also allowed to go for M.Phil. or Ph.D. in their respective fields;

Engineering, Medical, Agriculture and Commerce are specialized areas. The choice is not much wider for students. They have to study fixed subjects.



4. Curriculum Development

Curriculum development is the process of selecting, organizing, executing and evaluating learning experiences on the basis of needs, abilities and interests of the learners and the needs of the society. Curriculum provides the sketch of education required for the country. It sets direction for the needs and purpose of education, nature of institutions, quality of teachers, educational facilities and the system of examination and evaluation. Curriculum provides a scheme of compulsory, alternate compulsory and optional courses of studies.

Curriculum is prepared on certain basic principles which provide ideological, philosophical, religious and social basis to a nation. Pakistan's curriculum development is based on all these principles. Those who are involved

in the curriculum development are policy makers, subject specialists, textbook writers, publishers, parents and students.

In Pakistan preparation of curriculum is the task of Provinces after eighteenth amendments in constitution.

Curriculum of different subjects is being revised, updated and improved. The process of revision and updating of curriculum of all the subjects under different schemes of studies is continuous process and done regularly.

Curriculum development above Higher Secondary is the responsibility of Higher Education Commission. The Commission in collaboration with the Academic Councils in the Universities prepares, revise and, update the curriculum of the scheme of studies followed by the Universities.

5. Teacher Training

No system of education is above the level of its teachers. Teachers play a crucial role in the system of education. It is important that these teachers are equipped with proper knowledge, skills and attitudes in carrying out the goals of education and fulfilling their obligations.

Teachers' training has certain levels which correspond with the general education ability of the teachers. There are three levels of teachers training.

- i. **Primary school teachers:** Teachers for the primary schools are trained, and must have passed Secondary School examination. They are provided one year training. After completion of this training they are awarded certificate called Primary Teachers Certificate (PTC).
- ii. **Middle school teachers:** Those who possess given one year training and awarded a certificate called Certificate in Education (CT).

PTC and CT training is provided by the Government Colleges of Elementary Education (GCE). There are separate Elementary Colleges of Education for girls and boys which have been established at all the district headquarters within the country.

- iii. **Secondary school teachers:** Those who possess BA/B.Sc. degrees are provided one year training called “Bachelor of Education” (B.Ed.) at the Government Colleges of Education. These colleges are at a few selected places in each province of the country. Those who further want to specialize in the subject of education undergo one year course called Master in Education (M.Ed.). This course is conducted by the Colleges of Education and in the Institutes of Education in the Universities. Teachers also do M.Phil. and Ph.D. in Education from the Universities. Those who possess M.Ed. or M.Phil. teach in the Colleges of Education. At the University level Ph.Ds. are employed to train teachers.

Allama Iqbal Open University has started teacher training courses through its distance education- system for those students who cannot afford to attend formal regular courses in the teacher training institutions.

National Education Policy (1998-2010) provides for modernizing the courses in teacher training. Accordingly, the duration and period of training at all levels of training is being increased, including better salaries for the teachers.

There are few problems in the teacher-training programme which include non-availability of qualified teaching faculty for the Colleges of Education, quality training programmes, financial problems of the Training Institutions, lack of quality material for training and lack of effective system of management and supervision. But the most serious problem is that the teachers do not use those teaching skills and methods in their classes which were taught to them in the training institutions.

6. Textbook Development

It is considered as an essential element of educative process. Textbooks determine the level of education, level of its teachers and the standard of the system of education. Textbooks translate the objectives of education policy into reality and set the standard of education required for the development and progress of the country. Development of textbooks is an evolutionary process. It continues with the new developments and changes in the society and around the world. New information is incorporated in the textbooks, making them useful for the system of education.

For the development of textbooks government has set up Textbook Boards in all the four provinces. Subject Specialists have been appointed in these Boards, who continuously work for improving the textbooks written by the authors. The books developed by the Textbook Boards are further evaluated by the expert committees in different subjects constituted by the Curriculum Wing in the Ministry of Education. After the evaluation and approval of the government, these books become part of educational system and are taught in the educational institutions throughout the country.

7. Examinations

Examinations are the means to test the ability of students at different levels of education. These examinations are held at the end of each academic year. The examinations not only determine the ability of the students but also determine the standard of education of, an educational institution and its teachers. They also indicate overall characteristics of the system of education within the country.

Apart from regular system of examinations for each class at school level at the end of the year, there are the examinations conducted by the Boards of Examination called Board of Secondary and Higher Secondary Education. These Boards are established in all the provinces of Pakistan and at the Federal level. Those who pass these examinations are issued Certificates. Universities have their own system of examinations, which are conducted with the help and co-operation of the Colleges, in the jurisdiction of a particular University. But our system of examinations encourages selected study of the courses. Therefore, students do not develop the habit of regular study. The guesswork has put adverse effect on the study habits of the students. The only remedy is that the number of short answer questions should be increased in order to cover the whole course, which will result in detailed study of the courses by the students. The rampant cheating and malpractice in the examination system have minimized its importance. There is need to maintain a strict discipline in the system of examinations. Another aspect is the conduct of entry test for admission. This will help in developing study habits among the students.

8. Technical and Vocational Education

The present era is that of technical and vocational education which helps in sustainable economic and industrial development. Therefore, government has paid attention to improve technical and vocational education in the country. Polytechnic institutes have been set up at the level of each district headquarter.

Matric pass students are admitted in these institutes on the basis of their merit. The students are awarded Diploma in Technical Education. Government has started technical projects in the country whose objective is to provide physical facilities for technical education institutions, provide equipment, improve courses of technical education and prepare teachers for imparting technical education. A Science Education Project has also been started by the Government of Pakistan. The objective is to improve standard of education in the courses of Mathematics, Sciences and Computer Science. About 6 million students will benefit from these courses.

Government of Pakistan has established Ghulam Ishaque Khan (GIK) Institute of Technology at Topi in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, which is the highest modern institute of technical education, its standard is of International level.

A professional and vocational training institute and textile institute has been established at Faisalabad, which prepares experts for Textile Industry.

In Sindh, Polytechnic Institutes/Colleges are at Karachi, Hyderabad, Badin, Nawabshah and Sukkur. Technical institutes are also at the district headquarters in Sindh.

Government is stressing on technical and vocational education to prepare qualified and educated technical hands for improving the standard and level of our technical products for competing in the International market. Government is spending huge funds for the improvement of technical and vocational education.



9. Higher Education

Higher education is controlled by the Universities. During the last 20 years, Higher Education has made a speedier progress. At the time of creation of Pakistan there was only one University (Punjab University) and the plan of Sindh University (Jamshoro) was under consideration. By the year 2004 their number has increased to 53 in the Government Sector and 44 in the Private sector. Each year 2 to 3 more Universities are added in the private sector. In March 2002, Virtual University was set up with branches as under:-

Punjab	82	(21 in Lahore and remaining in other cities of Punjab)
Sindh	27	(24 in Karachi and 3 in other cities of Sindh)
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	9	(3 in Peshawar, 2 in Abbottabad and 1 each

Balochistan	3	in other 4 cities) (1 in Quetta and 2 in other cities)
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A major development in higher education was the establishment of Higher Education Commission on 14th August 2002. This Commission has set the following targets:

- Increasing access to higher education from 2.6% to 5% by 2005.
- Increasing enrolment from 100,000 to 200,000 students by 2005.
- Increasing allocation to higher education from 0.39% to 1% of GDP by 2005.
- Shift from Humanities to Science and Technology from current 70:30 ratio to 50:50 by 2005.
- Introducing Information Technology Education in all public sector universities.

10. Problems in Education

Following are our main problems in education: ·

i. Attitude of the Feudal

The feudal system is the major obstacle in the way of education of the poor children. The parents are poor and can hardly afford educational expenses of their children. On the other hand feudal lords in the rural areas have discouraged education of the children of poor parents. They want to employ poor children on little wages. This is the reason that literacy rate in the rural areas has not increased specially the education of female children has suffered much.

ii. Dropouts

At each stage of the education of the children dropout rate has increased. About 85% children are admitted in primary schools but hardly 56% children complete the 5 years cycle of primary education. At the middle stage a significant majority dropouts in the middle of their, education cycle. The economic condition of the parents is the main reason of dropouts because they cannot afford the educational expenses of their children.

iii. Teacher Absenteeism

In rural areas, teacher absenteeism has adversely affected the progress in education. Shortages of teachers in rural areas, ghost schools and lack of supervision of rural schools have resulted in low progress in the promotion of education and eradication of illiteracy.

iv. High fees of Private educational institutions

Private sector educational institutions charge high fees as compared to the facilities provided there. Teachers are overworked but paid low salaries. Government should exercise control over these schools. Registration fee in the private schools is from Rs.200 to Rs.10000 and monthly fee structure extends from Rs.200 to Rs.1000 and even more. Teachers in the private schools are less qualified and hence their standard is less than the teachers in the government schools

v. Shortage of physical facilities

The shortage of physical facilities and equipment in the primary schools has resulted in the decline in the level of education. About 25,000 primary schools are without proper buildings. Most of the schools have no boundary walls, no toilets and no water facilities. There is shortage of furniture in these schools. Most of the schools in the rural area are of one room school and are made of a mixture of mud and wood. These are known as Katcha Schools. These are in a very bad shape. The quality of education is poor in these schools.

vi. Non-availability of textbooks

Many pupils do not afford the high cost of textbooks. Textbooks prescribed by the private and English medium schools are very expensive. Textbooks of higher education and professional courses are mostly imported and are very expensive.

vii. Accommodation for students

Hostel accommodation for the students of Technical and Medical Colleges has become a problem. Hostels are not available as compared to the increasing number of students of these institutions.

viii. Political interference

Public representatives interfere in the administration of educational institutions especially in the appointment and transfer of teachers. Merit is ignored and appointments are made on favouritism or political recommendations.



11. New trends in education including Information Technology

After the end of 20th century and with the beginning of 21st century rapid changes have occurred in all sectors of human development. The systems of industry, trade and business, banking and insurance have become very complex. To solve this problem the departments of Management Sciences have played a significant role. Business administration has introduced a new system of office management, dominated by computers. New departments of banking, hotel management, tourism and investment accounts have been opened in the universities. The most popular institute in these disciplines is Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS).

Information Technology (IT) is an innovation in the field of telecommunication. Due to IT, data can be transferred to thousands kilometers away through the internet. Individuals and institutions have developed their websites, which provide the required information within no time. Internet has become source of quick means of transaction, imports and exports and acquisition of research material while sitting at home. Information technology needs skill and expertise to operate the machines. The important challenge in the IT in Pakistan is the availability of experts in the field. India has become self-sufficient in this field and thousands of its experts are in demand by USA, UK and Germany.

The importance of IT has been recognized in Pakistan. Investment has started on priority. Computer Hardware and Software are being prepared. Seven IT Universities are being established, 5 in the public or government sector and 2 in the private sector. Two IT universities namely "COMSATS" and "FAST" have started functioning. Formal Universities have also been advised by the government of Pakistan to establish the department of IT.

Information technology has been extended to over 4000 educational institutions, including schools in collaboration with private sector.

Hundreds of mushroom IT institutions have also been opened in the country but most of them neither have necessary equipment nor the expert

teachers. Such institutions are creating negative feelings about IT. The government should check spreading of such institutions.

IT has a bright future in Pakistan. A large number of foreign companies are making investment in IT on large scale.

The objectives of innovative- programme of IT education in Pakistan are:

- i. To modernize the educational system of Pakistan by introducing information technology at all levels.
- ii. To provide access to research and modern it information through the internet.
- iii. To familiarize information technology among the children of all ages and prepares them for the future.
- iv. To emphasize the varied roles of computers as a learning tool in the classroom.
- v. To employ communication technology for the training of teachers and other educational activities.



EXERCISE

A. Answer the following questions:

1. Describe the importance of education in the development of a country.
2. Highlight the important aspects of education as mentioned in the National Education Policy 1998 - 2010.
3. Mention the socio-cultural importance of education.
4. Describe the structure of formal education in Pakistan?
5. What are the main components of the scheme of studies at secondary level of education?
6. Write a note on the Teacher-Training Programme in Pakistan.
7. Describe the importance of Technical and Vocational education in Pakistan.
8. What are the educational problems of Pakistan?
9. Mention the objectives of IT education in Pakistan.

B. Fill in the blanks:

- i. No real progress is possible without _____.
- ii. First Educational Conference in Pakistan was held in the year _____.
- iii. Compulsory Primary Education Act was enforced in the year _____.
- iv. The first step of formal system of Education in Pakistan is _____.
- v. Professional Education includes _____, _____, _____, and _____ fields.
- vi. _____ is responsible for the preparation and development of textbooks in Sindh.

Chapter 10

PAKISTAN - A WELFARE STATE

A State that cares for the basic needs of its citizens and enables them to live a peaceful life is called a welfare state. The objectives of such a state are to eliminate illiteracy, poverty and injustice from the society and provide its citizens opportunities to help create environments conducive to the development of their innate potential. The opportunities are provided to all the citizens on equal terms.

The concept of modern Welfare state emerged In Europe as a reaction against the unequal distribution of wealth. This concept gained popularity in the 20th century and many European states introduced reforms for the welfare of their citizens. In the golden times, the duties of the state were confined to the security, maintenance of law and order and general administration of the country. But the duties of a welfare state include protection of life and property of its citizens on the one hand and on the other hand protection of their basic or fundamental rights. The state helps the backward and the handicapped on account of economic and other reasons so that they live a life at par with others. Introduction of social security system in the modern developed countries like USA, UK, Germany, France, Canada and Australia is a step forward towards welfare state. In a welfare state basic needs of the citizens are fulfilled and their welfare is the primary duty of the state. The people in a welfare state are, therefore, patriotic, bold and outspoken.

1. Islamic Perspective of a Welfare State

The idea of Welfare State is not new. Islam presented the concept of welfare state fourteen hundred years ago which was fully practiced during the period of Righteous Caliphs (Khilafat-e-Rashida 632-661 A.D). The concept of Islamic Welfare state includes:

- a. Sovereignty in Islam belongs to Almighty Allah. The state protects the life, property and honour of its individuals. Justice is for all without any discrimination. All are equal before law. The superiority among the individuals is based on Taqwa (fear of Allah).

- b. It is necessary for the one who runs the affairs of the Islamic Welfare State to adhere to the basic tents of Islam. He should be a God-fearing Muslim and act as a trustee only.
- c. The head of an Islamic Welfare state is the servant of the people. He always thinks about the welfare of its people. He lives a simple life like an ordinary man.
- d. The Islamic Welfare State is always accountable to its people. The ruler is not beyond question or criticism. Such a state develops a prosperous society, free of exploitation. It provides equal opportunities of progress to all the individuals. It provides all basic facilities to the individuals including the non-Muslims.
- e. In a nutshell the concept of an Islamic Welfare State is that it maintains "Musawat" i.e., (Equality at all levels).



2. National Goals of Pakistan

Pakistan is a sovereign Islamic state and its national objectives are:

i. Setting up an Islamic Society

The foremost national objective of Pakistan is the setting up of an Islamic Society as per the teachings of Islam and principles of democracy. Quaid-i-Azam had said that the purpose of the creation of Pakistan was not to just obtain a piece of land but the objective was to establish a laboratory where we could practice principles of Islam. Thus, it is the duty of every Pakistani to create such an atmosphere in which every person can lead his / her individual as well as collective life according to the principles of Islam.

ii. Struggle against exploitation

It is also our national objective to establish an Islamic polity, based on the principles of equality, social justice, mutual respect and cooperation. This is possible when people get equal opportunities for progress and prosperity and do not fall victim to ignorance, poverty and exploitation.

iii. State security.

It is the collective responsibility of the people and the government to safeguard the country from internal and external dangers. The protection of national identity and freedom is another important national goal.

iv. Self-sufficiency

Pakistan must be made economically self-sufficient. This would require sustained efforts at national level to work hard depend upon our own resources and promote education and scientific knowledge. A sense of "Pakistanism" is to be developed to become self-reliant.

v. Unity with Muslim countries

It is also our national objective to promote unity among the Islamic countries and unite them on one platform. We have to strengthen the role of Organization of Islamic Countries (OIC) so that a uniform stand is taken on the issues concerning the interests of Muslim Ummah.

vi. Peace initiatives

Promotion of international and regional peace, reformation of the unjust international economic system and elimination of racial discrimination are also our national objectives.

vii. Struggle for Welfare State

The most important objective is to make Pakistan a Welfare State. Our resources are limited. The only hurdle in making Pakistan a welfare state is that it has scanty resources. We should, therefore, develop our resources by improving literacy rate, promoting scientific and technical education and increasing industrial products. Elimination of social evils and corruption is inevitable for making Pakistan a welfare state.



3. Need for sustained constructive efforts

The nation which has the will to progress continues its efforts by using available resource to progress continuously on the road to self-sufficiency.

But it is not possible to transform a country into a welfare state overnight. This is a sustained and constant process. It has the following important aspects:

a. Awareness about the national goals

Only those nations progress whose people are aware about their national goals. These goals are always pre-fixed and help in determining the national priorities for speedy development. This can be achieved by careful planning and proper implementation. This process continues forever. Also constant struggle and strong will is necessary to achieve the goals.

b. Dignity of labour

It means that the people should be made conscious of the value and dignity of labour. The younger generation should be taught that progress and development without devotion and hard labour would merely be a dream. Quaid-i-Azam had advised the youth to feel dignity in work and make it as their aim in life. The sense of dignity of labour should generate and start from home.

c. Nature of Education

Progress cannot be achieved through general education alone. National resources can properly be utilized through advancement in scientific and technical knowledge. Therefore, it is necessary to accelerate the pace of national construction with the help of technical education and training.

d. Guidance and Encouragement

Since the independence of Pakistan in 1947 different sectors of our economy have shown a lot of progress. Agriculture and industry have progressed. A number of mega projects have been completed and some are in the process of completion. However, these guide and encourage the people of Pakistan to undertake progressive methods of production. But the need is to continue our struggle for more development and make Pakistan a Welfare State.

e. **Welfare Programmes**

As a part of constructive effort for sustained development, some welfare programmes for the disabled and needy people have been started within the country such as,

- i. Establishment of industrial homes for the female.
- ii. Establishment of Health Centers.
- iii. Educational institutions for the deaf and dumb.
- iv. Training Centers for physically handicapped persons.
- v. Recreational spots for general public.
- vi. Establishment of anti-begging centers.

4. Self-Sufficiency in Food

Food is the basic need of the people. Lack of proper or sufficient food for the people results in poor health. When people are not healthy, their efficiency to work will decrease. The development and construction process of the country will go down. Import of food from other countries will affect other sectors of development, especially the industrial development because valuable foreign exchanges will be spent on the import of food items.

Pakistan's economy depends upon its agriculture. Majority of the population of Pakistan is engaged in agriculture. Major part of national income is obtained from the agricultural products and industries based on agricultural output. Agricultural crops like rice and cotton are the major source of earning foreign exchange. Agriculture is also important for the industries. A number of industries like textile industry, sugar industry and vegetable oil industry are dependent on agriculture products. Agricultural development is not only necessary for food but also for industrial development. Industrial products are also used for the development of agriculture. By increasing agricultural products we will be able to:-

- i. Save valuable foreign exchange which is spent on the import of food stuff.
- ii. Establish more industries, increase products and earn foreign exchange.
- iii. Decrease in the foreign loans.
- iv. Increase people's purchasing power and improve quality of life.

- v. Flourish trade and business.
- vi. Provide job opportunities to people and eliminate poverty.

The government has been paying special attention to the development of agriculture sector with an objective to make the country self sufficient in food. For this purpose following steps have been taken:-

- i. Agriculture reforms have been introduced in the country to fix the maximum limit of land holding to protect the rights of peasants and the small land holders.
- ii. Special attention is given to agriculture in the Five Years Development Plans by allocating huge funds for the development of agriculture sector.
- iii. Water resources have been enhanced through construction of dams and construction of water canals in some new areas. Efforts are being made to line the canals and the water courses.
- iv. Steps have been taken to eradicate waterlogging and salinity through construction of outfall drain.
- v. Agricultural development banks and cooperative societies have been set up to give loans to the farmers.
- vi. A number of agricultural institutes have been set up. They are providing useful advice on agricultural problems and suggest healthy seeds and fertilizers for more production.
- vii. A number of facilities have been provided by the government to purchase fertilizers, pesticides, tractors and other related equipment.

As a result of government efforts, Pakistan has become self-sufficient or almost so in a number of agriculture products like rice, cotton, wheat, sugar, and chemical fertilizers. The foreign exchange saved from the import of food items is being spent on the establishment of industries. The day is not far when Pakistan will be self-sufficient in food.



5. Universal Education

Education is recognized as a basic and fundamental right of the individuals in Islam as well as in the UN Charter. Education should be free and compulsory up to a specific level for all citizens. After this level, equal opportunities are provided to all individuals for receiving higher education. This requires increase in the number of educational institutions and other facilities. In Pakistan efforts are in progress for attaining the target of universal education. Following steps have been taken to spread education in the country.

- i. Reforms in education known as Education Sector Reforms (ESR) have been introduced. The purpose of these reforms is to introduce a system which fulfills the need and obligation of independent ideological state of Pakistan. The new system will ensure access to every citizen to receive education.
- ii. The study of Islamiyat and Pakistan Studies is compulsory to make the children enlightened and better individuals by understanding the real spirit of Islam and the importance of Pakistan.
- iii. Steps are being taken to discourage the tendency of business in education. A plan is underway to provide free education up to class-x in a phased manner.
- iv. The service structure and service conditions of the teachers are being made better, enabling them to work with interest and devotion.
- v. A programme of award of scholarships to the meritorious and poor students has been started by Pakistan Bait-ul-Mal.
- vi. Awareness campaign has been started on Radio and Television to create interest among the people to educate their children, especially in the girls.
- vii. A programme namely "Education for All" (EFA) has been started throughout Pakistan. Under this scheme Non-formal basic

education at institutions have been opened in the rural areas. Books and educational material are provided in these institutions. The number of these institutions at present is around ten thousand (10,000) which will gradually rise to about eighty thousand (80,000).

- viii. A scheme of public-private partnership has been started. Under the scheme Non-government Organizations (NGOs) and Community Based Organizations (CBOs) will establish institutions in the rural areas to help government promote education and literacy.
- ix. Education Foundations have been set up in all the provinces and at Federal level to provide financial help to the private educational institutions.

6. Egalitarian Society

Egalitarian society upholds the principle of equality among the people. It remains stable and progressive so long the rights of the individuals are safeguarded. A society where social justice does not exist remains disturbed and eventually vanishes out. Social justice calls for the protection of life and property of the people, preservation of their honour and provision of basic civic facilities. Facilities of education, health and recreation are provided without discrimination. This will promote national integrity, love and cooperation among the individuals.

The Government of Pakistan has been making all out efforts to promote social justice for the establishment of an egalitarian society.

7. Universal brotherhood and peace

The present world has practically shrunk into a global village. Modern scientific developments, technologies and communications have reduced the distance. Nations of the world have come closer to each other. The conquest of space and the role of satellites have further reduced the distance. An atmosphere of brotherhood has come into existence. United Nations (UN) has also played a vital role in bringing the nation's of the world closer to each other. Now, problems of the world are common to all the nations. In the event of catastrophes, famines and destruction, countries of the world quickly come to the rescue of the affected part of the world.

Pakistan has all along acted in a responsible manner and has proved itself as a peace-loving country. It has always maintained cordial relations with all the

countries of the world. It has supported the UN to maintain peace in the world. Pakistan is a member of a number of world organizations which promote brotherhood and peace in the world.

As an Islamic country, Pakistan believes in the Islamic principles of peaceful coexistence. For universal brotherhood and peace an atmosphere of love among the nations is to be created. It is, therefore, necessary that disputes between different countries are peacefully and amicably resolved and the rights and freedom of every country is protected.



8. Just an equitable distribution of resources

When the resources are limited and the needs are on the increase, neither the resources can equitably be distributed nor can the dream of a welfare state be translated into reality. Moreover, the resources of all the countries are not the same or equal. Some areas have less resource resulting in the poor standard of living of the people. On the other hand some areas are fertile and people are living an easy and comfortable life. The resources mark the difference between the rich and the poor.

The welfare state can only be established when disparities in the society are removed and class conflict and regional bias are checked with balanced distribution of national resources.

There is a difference between the production and the resources, in different parts of Pakistan. Some areas are industrially developed and some are backward. Means of transport and communication are not equally developed throughout the country. The government has been trying to overcome these problems. A network of education is being set up throughout the country. The government has, therefore, taken the following steps for equitable distribution of resources.

- i. Education, health and social welfare institutions are being set up throughout the country.
- ii. Country-wide systems of award of scholarships have been established to provide financial assistance to deserving students.
- iii. Industries are being set up in the backward and deprived areas to create job opportunities for the people.
- iv. Household and cottage industries are patronized and encouraged to absorb the people in the local job market.

- v. Agricultural products are increased by providing number of incentives and facilities to the farmers and cultivators.
- vi. Amenities of life, like electricity, gas and telephone are being provided to the remote and far-flung areas.
- vii. Through the process of privatization people are being motivated to take part in the national development, programmes. Under this policy a few industries, factories and financial institutions have been privatized to enable private capitalists to share in the efforts of government for national development.
- viii. Labour laws have been modified. Through labour reforms rights of the workers have been protected. The protection is in the form of job security, participation in the management of the institutions, annual bonus and compensation in case of accident.



9. Role of an individual in a Welfare State

When a welfare state is supposed to meet all the basic needs of its citizens, the citizens are also required to fulfill their obligations towards the state. Following are some important duties of an individual:

- i. To remain loyal to the state and get ready for sacrifice at the time of a test.
- ii. To show respect to the rights of the fellow citizens and protect their life, honour and property.
- iii. Not to misuse the facilities provided by the state for general public, like electricity, gas, water supply system, public parks, means of transport and public property.
- iv. To take part individually or collectively in the welfare activities.
- v. To keep the environments clean.
- vi. To pay the taxes regularly and not to damage government or private property at the time of protest or agitation. For example, damaging vehicles, traffic signals, shops etc.

- vii. To share hands in the welfare projects. He or she should start welfare projects on self-help basis.
- viii. To help poor, handicapped and needy people in the neighborhood.
- ix. To help government against the activities of anti-social elements.
- x. To receive education, learn skills and utilize natural resources to accelerate the pace of progress.

EXERCISE

A. Answer the following questions:

1. What is meant by a Welfare State?
2. Describe the duties of a Welfare State.
3. What is the concept of an Islamic Welfare State?
4. What are the national goals of Pakistan?
5. Why is the self-sufficiency in food necessary?
6. Why peace in the world is necessary?
7. What is the role of an individual in a Welfare State?
8. What steps have been taken by the Government for universal education?
9. Write a note on egalitarian society.
10. Why are the sustained constructive efforts necessary for Pakistan?

B. Fill in the blanks with suitable words:

- i. Government is making efforts to establish an _____ society in Pakistan.
- ii. _____ of the population in Pakistan is associated with agriculture.
- iii. Pakistan is self-sufficient in the production of _____ and _____.
- iv. Sovereignty in Islam belongs to _____.
- v. Economic development leads to _____.

Chapter 11

THE CIVIC LIFE IN PAKISTAN

1. Democratic Government

The democratic government is that form of government in which right of governance is not the prerogatives of any individual of a political party and in its stead, the elected representative of the people enjoy the power to govern during the currency of their tenure. In a democratic set-up the people elect their rulers and have a say in framing and implementing the policies of the government. Democracy means government of the people, by the people and for the people.

2. Democracy as Freedom of Expression

Each citizen enjoys the freedom of speech, writing and expression of his feelings or views. He can bring his personal views or reactions through speech and writing on all domestic and foreign affairs, provided it is in the interest of the nation and the country. The freedom of expression covers public speeches, writing of books and pamphlets and as, such a democratic governments grants due freedom to newspapers and publications. Besides, the freedom of expression, a democratic order grants to its citizens the personal freedom, freedom of faith and professions, movement of the people and right to else a legal livelihood and the government affords equal treatment to all Democracy affords peace and tranquility to people. In most of the countries of the world, democracy alone is the popular form of government.

3. The Functioning of a Democratic Government

Democracy as the government of the people does not mean that every citizen participates in the government. The government is run by a few representatives of the people. You might be having a student's council in your school. All students elect their class representatives and these elected representatives run the students council on behalf of the students of the school. Similarly, all citizens elect their representatives by voting. The elected

representatives constitute the assembly. Various political parties field their candidates who are elected by the common voters. The political party having a majority in the assembly elects one of its elected members as Prime Minister who chooses ministers (members of cabinet) runs the government during the tenure of the assembly. If at any time the majority of the members of the assembly fail to support the government, then the latter resigns and new election has to take place. Each government tries its best to fulfill the promises made to the general people. The views of the people are given their due place because it is the opinion of the people which matters in the making or unmaking of the government.



4. The Rights and Duties of Citizens

In common parlance the resident of a city is known as citizen. But when it comes to the rights and duties of citizens, it covers all people, be they dwellers of cities or villages and all citizens have same rights and same obligations (duties).

Rights of Citizen or Civil Rights

i. Personal Freedom

It is everybody's right to be free in his thoughts and deeds, provided these do not harm others. It is his right to enjoy freedom of his person and no one should be arrested or imprisoned without sufficient justification. He has the right to move and reside in any part of the country.

He has right to go anywhere for trade, employment or excursion (picnic, sightseeing and recreation). Similarly, he has the right to adopt any profession for his livelihood, provided it is not an illegal, immoral or disastrous for others.

ii. Freedom of Expression and Religious Freedom

Every citizen has to enjoy the freedom of speech and writing so that he can express his views. His newspapers and magazines should also be free. No one has the right to express such views which may lead to commotion or which involves defamation or which is against the country or

which may lead to a civil riot. Each citizen has the right to adopt and practice any religion but no one has the right to speak against any other religion.

iii. Access to Education and Health

Education is a basic requirement. In the interest of society as a whole, it is necessary that all people have access to education, but it does not mean that the state has to make available all educational facilities from primary to the higher levels. Generally, it is the duty of the state to provide primary education to all its citizens and after that the state has to go as the resources permit. The access to health care is also a basic requirement.

Along with the above rights, a citizen has certain duties or obligations as well.

5. Duties or Obligations of Citizen

i. Respect for Law and Loyalty to the Country

It is the prime duty of each citizen to have respect for the law and act accordingly. Any society can have the real discipline if everybody follows law. The next obligation of each citizen is to be loyal to the country. He should desist from working against the national interests and should refrain from joining any movement which is disloyal to the country. Each citizen should be ready to sacrifice his life and property for the national defence and survival and can play an important role in eradicating the curse of drugs and other intoxicants in the country.

ii. Perception for the Rights of Others

A good citizen is under obligation to care for the rights of others. The rights desired by him also belong to others. Honesty in business and professional dealings, justice in matters involving others and strict observance of state laws and directives. It is in the interest of the society

as a whole that everybody fulfills his obligations and cares for the right of others.

iii. Duties or Obligations of Citizen

As students are also citizens, they have their obligations. As long as they are students, it is their duty to complete their education with devotion and dedication. During vacation or free hours, they can undertake such national duties as providing adult education or extending help in the task of Red Crescent. They can get training in civil defence. They can collect cash and consumable articles for sufferers of national disaster. They should respect their teachers and their elder. Like all other citizens, they too have to respect the laws of the country and have to be faithful to the country.



6. The Role of Individual in Society

No one can lead life in isolation. He has to meet his needs as a member of the society. Since times immortal, wherever the people have resided, they have led a life of social togetherness. Each individual has such requirements of life to meet that he is bound to lead a collective life. The collective life means living with and working for others. In other words, each individual is an ingredient of society and he has to lead a collective life. He is important only as a member of the society and separable he is reduced to a non-entity. Our great philosopher poet, Allama Iqbal has rightly said:

"An individual survives not in isolation but in national rapport".

You and I survive only through, collective or social interaction and are reduced to naught by avoiding it.

The welfare of any society rests on full discharge of an individual's responsibility. Each individual should be of sterling character based on highest moral values. It is in this way that the society improves and country makes progress and in its absence there occurs hurdles in the way of national advancement.

Each member of a society wants to lead a life of comfort and prosperity and wants to make progress but in a good society no person deprives others of their rights for his welfare and progress and in its stead is always ready to help others. He harms none and makes none suffer by his doings. He discharges all obligations (with full efforts and devotion) enjoined on him by the society on collective aspect of life. Every person must have a full perception of the fact that it is only through high character and noble disposition that one can contribute to collective welfare and has to work for it. We must show due respect to all individuals and hold their accusations in high esteem. All the people who belong to our nation should live like members of one family. It is the duty of every individual to help check the growing trend of drug-addiction among our youth.

7. Law and Freedom

We know that in a democratic government, people enjoy a lot of freedom. Their lives and properties are protected, but these freedoms do not entitle a person to do whatever he likes and no one can stop or question his behaviour for that would destroy the very fabric social order. Accordingly, each individual enjoys freedom to the extent provided in the laws of the land and only as long as he does not infringe upon the rights of others. The doings of a person within the bounds of law alone guarantee freedom.

Some people do not realise their responsibility and work against the government or social order and destroy the administrative order of the country. Accordingly, laws are made to suit the circumstances of the country and people are made to follow the laws. It is the law which sets the boundaries of mutual relationship and also explains as to how far the state can go in this regard. The law puts limits on individual's freedom so that no one could trample upon the rights of others by taking undue advantages of his freedom. It is the levity which affords justice to the people and provides stability to the government and

provides opportunity to the people to lead a life of comfort and prosperity. This is why it is the obligation of each citizen to respect the laws of the land while exercising his limits of freedom.

The courts function in each country for enforcement of laws and punish those who violate the laws. The laws are generally of two types, one relating to property, monetary transactions or civil rights are known as civil laws, the other relating to control of drubbing, murder, looting, theft and dacoity are known as criminal laws.

The law determines the limits of freedom. Freedom is rightly used when one knows its limits. The freedom and law are inter-related. The freedom becomes dangerous in the absence of law. It is obligatory on each individual to bind himself to laws and to keep his activities within the legal limits.



8. Disobedience to the Law / Corruption

In your home your parents make some rules which all the members of the family have to follow. For example, they may fix a time when everyone has to get up in the morning. A rule may require you to study for two hours every day. Your parents will have also told you the consequence of breaking the rules. For example, you may not be allowed to watch television if you have not studied for two hours. Why do you think your parents make these rules? Why do you think there are some consequences for breaking the rules?

Just as there in the rules in the home that all the family members have to follow, every country has laws that all its citizens must follow. Laws are essential for the functioning of a society. Without laws everyone would be free to do whatever they liked. There would be complete disorder in society. It would become very difficult for citizens to live in peace and prosper.